

Llewellyn van der Merwe

Director | Senior Architectural Engineer of Intelligent Software and Systems

A concise, third-person account of a senior software and systems architect whose public work demonstrates platform engineering, code generation, infrastructure ownership and sustained open-source leadership.



Professional profile

INDEPENDENT ASSESSMENT

Llewellyn van der Merwe is best characterised as a senior architectural engineer who remains hands-on across the entire delivery chain: design, code, data, release, Linux infrastructure, security, deployment, maintenance and intelligent automation.

His strongest technical centre is PHP/Joomla platform engineering. That specialisation is supported by C++ certification and study, Python and Bash automation, JavaScript/CSS delivery, relational databases, Docker, networking, OPNsense, self-hosted services, local AI models and agent-oriented workflows. He has worked in software since 2008 and systems administration since 2010.

Professional title

Director | Senior Architectural Engineer of Intelligent Software and Systems

Senior Software & Systems Architect | PHP/Joomla Platform Engineer | Linux/DevOps & Applied AI

268

REPOSITORIES INSPECTED

Across the thirteen supplied public estates

161

REPOSITORY OBJECTS

Public repositories with attributable commit history

4.000

COLLEGE GPA

Recorded in the supplied 2020 degree audit

Core value proposition

- Designs platforms and developer tools, not only end-user features.
- Can independently take a system from data model and backend through interface, packaging, hosting and operations.
- Brings production judgment from continuous responsibility for Linux servers, networking, firewalls, backups and live client systems.
- Has long-term open-source and Joomla leadership experience across architecture, production, testing, mentoring, Docker and community delivery.
- Applies local AI models and agent orchestration on top of established software-architecture and automation foundations.

Capabilities and selected evidence

TECHNICAL PROFILE

Domain	Level / emphasis	Demonstrated scope
PHP / Joomla	Senior / architectural	Large platform and extension ecosystems, reusable frameworks, APIs, code generation, compatibility and long-term stewardship.
Software architecture	Senior / principal scope	Domain modelling, system decomposition, developer tooling, generator/compiler processes, integration, release and evolution.
Data and APIs	Senior applied	Relational design, SQL, migrations, query modelling, data services, application integration and high-volume Bible-data systems.
Linux / DevOps	Advanced	Linux servers, Docker, Bash, deployment, backups, networking, access control, firewalls and OPNsense.
C++	Certified	Certified C++ Programmer; A grades in C++ Programming I and II; supporting public work where applicable.
Python / Shell	Proficient to advanced	Automation, data work, operations, AI tooling and repeatable system workflows.
JavaScript / CSS	Proficient production use	Browser logic, AJAX, interface construction, templating and responsive client/product work.
AI systems	Current applied practice	Local model deployment, inference infrastructure, tool/API integration and multi-agent engineering workflows.

Leading public engineering evidence

- **joomengine/Joomla-Component-Builder**—Professional-grade Joomla extension development engine and full-stack build pipeline supporting Joomla 3 through 6, reusable powers, blueprint modelling, multi-version compilation, packaging, and Git-backed distribution. 959 attributable commits, 7.75M recorded additions + deletions; Principal / architect.
- **trueChristian/Joomla-Sermon-Distributor**—A complete Joomla sermon-library and distribution application. 75 attributable commits, 941k recorded additions + deletions; Senior / architect.
- **trueChristian/daily-light**—A maintained Daily Light publishing system that generates and distributes devotional Scripture content. 4,312 attributable commits, 212k recorded additions + deletions; Senior / architect.
- **getbible/v2**—Second-generation GetBible JSON API and queryable scripture data distribution, including translation, book, chapter, verse, and integrity/hash material. 32 attributable commits, 6.42M recorded additions + deletions; Senior.
- **namibia/CBP-Joomla-3-Component**—Cost Benefit Projection component for Joomla 3.x 65 attributable commits, 1.06M recorded additions + deletions; Senior / architect.

Metric reading. Public Git evidence is a lower bound because proprietary work is excluded. Large delivered commits and JCB-generated output remain counted, while line volume is not treated as a direct conversion to hours or quality.

Experience and responsibility

PROFESSIONAL CHRONOLOGY

Vast Development Method

2013–present

Founder, director, architect and hands-on engineer

SUBJECT-CONFIRMED Leads consultancy, platform engineering, client applications, self-hosted infrastructure and continuing support. The operating pattern is a small team with substantial individual ownership across architecture, implementation and production.

Software engineering

2008–present

Web, application, platform and intelligent-systems practice

Progressed from web and visual delivery into PHP/Joomla application architecture, reusable tooling, APIs, C++/Python/Bash work, infrastructure and present-day AI systems.

Systems administration

2010–present

Linux infrastructure and operational continuity

SUBJECT-CONFIRMED Maintains servers, application hosting, databases, Docker services, domains, backups, networking and firewalls. Current responsibilities include OPNsense, Gitea, Vaultwarden and local AI infrastructure.

Selected client and institutional work

Client / programme	Period	Responsibility
NamPharm	2016–present	Subject-confirmed: pharmacist ordering portal; continuing application work; since 2022, Gitea, Vaultwarden and multiple servers/infrastructure.
East African Community	2017–present	Subject-confirmed: main website and related systems, hosting and operational support for the regional intergovernmental organisation.
EU–EAC MARKUP	2019–present	Subject-confirmed: website/application delivery and maintenance in the EAC, ITC and EU programme context.
Logo Embroidery	2016–present	Subject-confirmed: job-card and production workflow system from material ordering to completion.
Coral	2019	Subject-confirmed: biokinetics evaluation, reporting and practice/member management platform.
GIZ-linked projects	2014, 2016	Subject-confirmed: staff-health cost-benefit projection and support-group application for the Tonata PLHIV Network.

Continuing relationships also include systems, sites, hosting, domain or maintenance work for a range of Namibian organisations documented in the full dossier. Proprietary code volumes are intentionally not claimed.

Open source, leadership and teaching

PUBLIC RESPONSIBILITY

Joomla and Joomla Component Builder

Joomla Component Builder is the clearest single expression of the subject's architectural depth: a platform that models and generates Joomla software across versions, supported by reusable powers/services, packaging, repositories, releases and documentation. Its canonical public history alone records 4,624,219 additions and 3,129,642 deletions attributable under the confirmed identities, including delivered generated output.

The official Joomla volunteer record documents work across architecture and strategy, production, operations, testing, Google Summer of Code mentoring/leadership, the Joomla Extensions Directory, infrastructure/web teams, Docker maintenance, Security Team service and Afrikaans localisation.

Speaking

His speaking history spans colleges and technical communities, including algorithms, design patterns, Joomla engineering, pre-AI discussions and current intelligent-system practice. Public milestones include the Joomla Forum for the Future in Marbella (2020), a JoomlaDay USA JCB presentation (2021), the subject-confirmed Anabaptist Code Blocks Summit presentation in Pennsylvania and listing as a scheduled Joomla World Conference 2026 speaker in Germany.

Working style

Evidence suggests high autonomy, long attention span and comfort with systems that must keep working for years. The small-team record should be read as breadth and cost-efficient ownership, while an employer should still explore collaborative design practice, review habits and delegation in interview.

Education, certification and personal foundation

FORMAL AND SELF-DIRECTED LEARNING

Education and credentials

- **Certified C++ Programmer**—Concentrated Studies in C++ Programming (2020); C++ Programming I and II both graded A in the supplied Champlain audit.
- **Champlain College, Bachelor of Science in Web Design and Development study, 2019–2022**—degree not completed; he reports that study ended after COVID-related disruption. Supplied audit dated 24 August 2020: 30 institutional credits, 4.000 GPA and A grades in every listed completed course.
- Completed subjects include networking, computer systems, operating systems, relational database design and SQL, project management, written communication, discrete mathematics and C++ Programming I/II.
- Thirty-four additional recorded courses (2011–2015) across PHP/MySQL, object-oriented design, MVC, Java, JavaScript/AJAX/JSON, Node.js, NoSQL, Linux, regular expressions, HTML/CSS, jQuery, Joomla development and visual design.

Comparative standing. The public portfolio and professional history provide strong evidence across many baccalaureate software/computing outcomes and advanced professional depth in architecture, construction, maintenance, operations and leadership. This is a prior-learning comparison against ABET, SWEBOK V4 and SFIA 9—not a claim that an uncompleted degree or postgraduate title was awarded.

Mission, communication and service

Llewellyn reports a decisive Christian conversion in 1998, full-time mission work from 2000, establishment of the Windhoek church in 2004 and service as an elder from 2026. An audit of supplied ministry media found 444 distinct audio records (about 249.67 hours) from 2021–2025, of which 437 are at least five minutes long. A separate public playlist contains 387 services (about 438.86 hours) from 2018–2023. Because the collections may overlap, their totals are not added.

For a professional reader, this record demonstrates long-form preparation, public communication, continuity and service. Faith is included because it is central to the subject's identity, while the application remains led by software-engineering evidence.

Role fit and contact

Best suited to roles requiring senior autonomy across software architecture, platform engineering, developer tooling, PHP/Joomla systems, Linux/DevOps, integration or applied intelligent systems.

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This concise CV is derived from the accompanying investigative dossier and evidence ledger, current to 18 July 2026. It is a commissioned AI-assisted third-person assessment, not an external background check or academic credential award.